

Throttle To attack or kill someone by choking or strangling; strangle

Synonyms Gag, Smother

Antonyms Release, Let go

- A leader was throttled by the Maoists.

Tirade A long, angry speech of criticism or accusation

Synonyms Diatribe, Invective

Antonyms Compliment, Praise

- The coach directed a tirade at the team after the loss.

Titanic Extremely powerful, strong, important or large

Synonyms Colossal, Gigantic

Antonyms Small, Puny

- A titanic wave let the Titanic sink in.

Titter To give a short, half-suppressed laugh; giggle

Synonyms Giggle, Snigger

Antonym Cry

- He was tittering on his joke.

Toothsome (Especially of food) attractive or pleasant

Synonyms Tasty, Delicious

Antonyms Unpleasant, Unsavoury

- Pizza is a toothsome food for this generation.

Torpid Having or showing very little energy or movement; not active

Synonyms Lethargic, Inactive

Antonyms Energetic, Active

- The torpid boy is becoming obese day-by-day.

Tout 1. To publicise; praise excessively
2. To sell tickets unofficially, usually at a much higher rate than the official price

Synonyms Laud, Praise

Antonyms Criticise, Blame

- A local car dealership was touting its wares on the radio.



Ubiquitous Existing everywhere; omnipresent

Synonyms Universal, Prevalent

Antonyms Rare, Scarce

- Reliance Jio's advertisements are ubiquitous.

Umbrage A feeling of being offended by what someone had said or done

Synonyms Annoyance, Chagrin

Antonyms Calmness, Comfort

- Will she take umbrage if she isn't invited to the party?

Unabashed Without any worry about possible criticism or embarrassment

Synonyms Brazen, Unashamed

Antonyms Ashamed, Sheepish

- He is an unabashed capitalist.

Unassuaged Not soothed or relieved

Synonyms Annoyed, Complaining

Antonyms Contented, Pleased

- The customer is unassuaged with the services.

Unbridled Not controlled or limited

Synonyms Unrestricted, Unrestrained

Antonyms Controlled, Restrained

- The unbridled riot caused a lot of damage.

Undiscerning Lacking judgement, insight or taste

Synonyms Obtuse, Indiscriminate

Antonyms Insightful, Perceptive

- The situation showed undiscerning character of the lady.

Unequivocal Leaving no doubt; unambiguous

Synonyms Unambiguous, Absolute

Antonyms Ambiguous, Doubtful

- The church is unequivocal in its condemnation of the violence.

Unexpurgated (of a text) Complete and containing all the original material; uncensored

Synonyms Exhaustive, Entire

Antonyms Censored, Abridged

- Unexpurgated material has been sent for proof-reading now.



Vanity 1. Excessive pride in or admiration of one's own appearance or achievements.

2. The quality of being worthless or futile

Synonyms Egotism, Conceit

Antonyms Modesty, Humility

- Vanity of a person thwarts his path of progress.

Vanquish To defeat thoroughly

Synonyms Conquer, Tounce

Antonyms Surrender, Yield

- The school team was vanquished in the match.

Vaunt Boast about or praise something, especially excessively

Synonyms Boast, Brag

Antonyms Deprecate, Condemn

- Even the noblest of fellows have been known to vaunt a bit.

Vehement Expressing strong feelings; forceful, passionate or intense

Synonyms Forceful, Passionate

Antonyms Mild, Apathetic

- The proposal has faced vehement opposition from many people.

Venal Willing to do dishonest things in return for money

Synonyms Corrupt, Crooked

Antonyms Honest, Ethical

- The country wants to get rid of venal leaders.

Venerable Valued and respected because of old age, long use etc

Synonyms Revered, Esteemed

Antonyms Dishonourable, Disreputable

- The Hindu is a venerable newspaper.

Venerate To honour or greatly respect a person or thing

Synonyms Respect, Exalt

Antonyms Denounce, Condemn

- The Ganges is a venerated river in India.

Verity An important principle or fact that is always true

Synonyms Accuracy, Veracity

Antonyms Falseness, Falsehood

- Revolution of Earth on its axis is a verity.

Verve Great energy and enthusiasm

Synonyms Vigour, Enthusiasm

Antonyms Lethargy, Inactivity

- *She delivered her speech with tremendous verve.*

Vindicate To clear someone of blame or suspicion, to prove to be right or reasonable, to justify

Synonyms Justify, Acquit

Antonyms Blame, Charge

- *The investigation vindicated her complaint about the newspaper.*

Virulent 1. (of a disease or poison) Extremely severe or harmful in its effects.

2. Full of hate and violent opposition

Synonyms Fatal, Malicious

Antonyms Harmless, Amicable

- *There is a virulent relation between India and Pakistan these days.*

Vitiate To spoil or impair the quality or efficiency of something

Synonyms Annihilate, Spoil

Antonyms Fix, Mend

- *Mishandling has vitiated the quality of machines.*

Voracious Insatiable appetite for food, facts/knowledge.

Synonyms Insatiable, Uncontrollable

Antonyms Satiated, Controllable

- *As a child, I had a voracious appetite for books.*

W

Wallop To strike or hit very hard

Synonyms Bash, Batter

- *The peon was walloping the bell continuously.*

Whimper To make a series of low, feeble sounds expressive of fear, pain or discontent

Synonyms Sob, Whine

Antonyms Laugh, Chuckle

- *The dog that met with the accident was whimpering in front of the office.*

Whisk To take or move someone or something somewhere suddenly and quickly

Synonyms Dart, Dash

Antonyms Drag, Slow

- *The sacks of grain were whisked to the godown for fear of rain.*

Whit A very small part or amount

Synonyms Scrap, Bit

Antonyms Lot, Whole

- *The child accepted only a whit of the chocolate.*

Wistful Sad and thinking about

something that is impossible or past

Synonyms Contemplative, Nostalgic

Antonyms Cheerful, Happy

- *I thought about my childhood days and grew wistful.*

X

Xenophobic Extreme dislike or fear of foreigners, their customs, their religions etc.

Synonyms Animosity, Chauvinism

Antonyms Tolerance, Impartiality

- *Tourist guides cannot be xenophobic.*

Y

Yank To pull something with a quick movement

Synonyms Jerk, Tug

Antonym Push

- *The man yanked at the zip of the bag.*

Z

Zany Strange, surprising or uncontrolled in an amusing way

Synonyms Bizarre, Eccentric

Antonyms Familiar, Sensible

- *His zany behaviour is beyond explanation.*

Zest Enthusiasm, eagerness, energy and interest

Synonyms Enthusiasm, Guts

Antonyms Apathy, Indifference

- *His humour added zest to the performance.*

03

SYNONYMS

Generally, 8-12 questions are asked on synonyms in the CDS exam. The questions can be in a direct format or sentence format. A candidate is expected to have a good vocabulary to solve these questions correctly.



Synonyms are the words which have a similar meaning to that of a given word.

e.g. The synonyms of the word reside is 'dwell'.

Questions on synonyms can be asked directly or in a sentence format in the CDS exam.

1. Direct Format

In this format a word is given and out of the given four options, a word is to be selected which is the nearest in meaning to the given word.

e.g. Which of the given words is **closest** in meaning to the word provided?

REMOTE

- (a) Automatic (b) Distant (c) Mean (d) Savage

Explanation (b) Remote means located far away and 'Distant' also means 'far away in space or time'. While, Automatic means done or occurring spontaneously; Mean means intend to convey or refer to and Savage means cruel and vicious. So, the right synonym for 'Remote' is 'Distant'. Hence, option (b) is the correct choice.

2. Sentence Format

In this format one word of a sentence is underlined or capitalized and out of the given four options, a word is to be selected which is similar in meaning to the underlined or capitalized word.

e.g. Which of the given words has the same meaning to the word written in **capital** letters?

Getting a WEAK mobile signal in remote areas is quite common.

- (a) Fluctuating (b) Falling (c) Low (d) Distant

Explanation (c) In this sentence 'Weak' means 'Low' mobile signal. While, Fluctuating (rise and fall); Falling (drop down) and Distant (far away) have different meanings. Hence, option (c) is the correct choice.



CHECK YOUR VOCABULARY

FIND THE SYNONYM OF GIVEN WORDS

Directions (Q. Nos. 1-75) *In the following items, which of the given words is **closest** in meaning to the words provided.*

- 1. MODEST**
(a) Attractive (b) Clever
(c) Current (d) Humble
- 2. CUSTOM**
(a) Dessert (b) Habit
(c) Ethic (d) Deliver
- 3. PROLONG**
(a) Extend (b) Inquire
(c) Relax (d) Wait
- 4. HUSTLE**
(a) Dance (b) Hurry
(c) Busy (d) Clean
- 5. SOLEMN**
(a) Amusing (b) Harmful
(c) Speech (d) Serious
- 6. IMPLY**
(a) Suggest (b) Stab
(c) Thick (d) Destroy
- 7. RAMBLE**
(a) Knot (b) Confuse
(c) Wander (d) Wonder
- 8. BENEFICIAL**
(a) Doleful (b) Advantageous
(c) Playful (d) Ignoble
- 9. FLARE**
(a) Judicial (b) Temper
(c) Style (d) Blaze
- 10. NEGLIGENT**
(a) Pajamas (b) Morbid
(c) Careless (d) Dark
- 11. ALOOF**
(a) Above (b) Tidy
(c) Clever (d) Reserved
- 12. RESOLVE**
(a) Turn (b) Puzzle
(c) Decide (d) Want
- 13. CONGREGATE**
(a) Worship (b) Gather
(c) Disturb (d) Hurry
- 14. UTTER**
(a) Express (b) Defer
(c) Borrow (d) Laugh
- 15. FEARLESS**
(a) Powerful (b) Cowardly
(c) Brave (d) Careful
- 16. NEGLIGIBLE**
(a) Insignificant (b) Arguable
(c) Careless (d) Dark
- 17. PLACID**
(a) Calm (b) Lazy
(c) Solemn (d) Devious
- 18. RAKE**
(a) Thin (b) Scoundrel
(c) Gentleman (d) Shove
- 19. DUPE**
(a) Rancher (b) Trick
(c) Simpleton (d) Drug
- 20. STIGMA**
(a) Stain (b) Trial
(c) Difficulty (d) Holiness
- 21. RESIDE**
(a) Remain (b) Home
(c) Dwell (d) Sediment
- 22. COVETOUS**
(a) Quiet (b) Sneaky
(c) Lurking (d) Greedy
- 23. ABIDE**
(a) Endure (b) Hate
(c) Attendance (d) Live
- 24. SHREWD**
(a) Intractable (b) Mean
(c) Astute (d) Intelligent
- 25. FETTER**
(a) Rancid (b) Praise
(c) Hamper (d) Persist
- 26. FLAGRANT**
(a) Vibrant (b) Glaring
(c) Vicious (d) Pleasant
- 27. MITIGATE**
(a) Relieve (b) Blend
(c) Defend (d) Confuse
- 28. RAIL**
(a) Scold (b) Push
(c) Try (d) Punish
- 29. MELD**
(a) Character (b) Distinction
(c) Blend (d) Firmness
- 30. RALLY**
(a) Demonstrate (b) Muster
(c) Course (d) Truly
- 31. ABJECT**
(a) Indigent (b) Desire
(c) Deplorable (d) Extreme
- 32. BESPOKE**
(a) Gentle (b) Quiet
(c) Tailored (d) Handsome
- 33. DIFFIDENT**
(a) Apathetic (b) Shy
(c) Arrogant (d) Quarrelsome
- 34. PROFFER**
(a) Mendicant (b) Wastrel
(c) Predict (d) Tender
- 35. MORDANT**
(a) Dead (b) Gruesome
(c) Fetid (d) Caustic
- 36. CHURLISH**
(a) Childish (b) Boorish
(c) Tempestuous (d) Disorderly
- 37. ANTEDILUVIAN**
(a) Antiquated (b) Parched
(c) Non-sectarian (d) Non-sensical
- 38. PICAYUNE**
(a) Petty (b) Spicy
(c) Paltry (d) Southern
- 39. SMITE**
(a) Flee (b) Speck
(c) Dirt (d) Strike
- 40. WINNOW**
(a) Carve (b) Wind
(c) Weed (d) Carry
- 41. EXPLOIT**
(a) Utilise (b) Alert
(c) Support (d) Neglect
- 42. DETRIMENTAL**
(a) Demolition (b) Aversion
(c) Beneficial (d) Harmful
- 43. SHARP**
(a) Bleakly (b) Bluntly
(c) Exactly (d) Blond
- 44. CONDEMN**
(a) Censure (b) Approve
(c) Recommend (d) Praise
- 45. RELUCTANT**
(a) Disinclined (b) Anxious
(c) Refuse (d) Eager
- 46. INTRICATE**
(a) Complicated (b) Simple
(c) Colourful (d) Good
- 47. PENURY**
(a) Pompous (b) Luxury
(c) Poverty (d) Punitive

48. EXPOSTULATE

- (a) Protest (b) Agree
(c) Follow (d) Argue

49. ABSURD

- (a) Senseless (b) Clean
(c) Abrupt (d) Candid

50. PHILANTHROPY

- (a) Generosity (b) Perversity
(c) Perjury (d) Flaunting

51. TRAIPSE

- (a) Run
(b) Sleep
(c) Laze around
(d) Walk or move wearily or reluctantly

52. MUNIFICENCE

- (a) Being too proud
(b) Being too honest
(c) Being very generous
(d) Being very stingy

53. EMBELLISH

- (a) Spoil (b) Decorate
(c) Bother (d) Facilitate

54. BASK

- (a) Lie exposed to warmth and light
(b) Lie exposed to cold
(c) Boast
(d) Basket

55. SKITTISH

- (a) Nervous (b) Confident
(c) Clever (d) Contradicting

56. SEAMLESS

- (a) Horrid
(b) Smooth and Continuous
(c) Succulent
(d) Rough

57. INQUITOUS

- (a) Sinful (b) Remorseful
(c) Curious (d) Argumentative

58. IMplode

- (a) Shake
(b) Collapse outwards
(c) Collapse inwards
(d) Soothe

59. IMPUGN

- (a) Praise (b) Custom
(c) Purge (d) Challenge

60. BANQUET

- (a) Lunch
(b) Fast
(c) Formal evening meal
(d) Breakfast

61. PULVERISE

- (a) Celebrate
(b) Condemn publically
(c) Confiscate
(d) Reduce to fine particles

62. BUCOLIC

- (a) Urban (b) Foreign
(c) Middle-class (d) Rural

63. SNARE

- (a) Trap (b) Rest house
(c) Release (d) Alley

64. LITTORAL

- (a) Literal
(b) Situated on the shore
(c) Situated on the mountains
(d) Pictorial

65. HUBBUB

- (a) Calm (b) Network
(c) Noisy situation (d) A device

66. ACCOST

- (a) To address someone politely
(b) To demonetise
(c) To cheat someone
(d) To address someone boldly

67. BEGUILING

- (a) Accusing (b) Enchanting
(c) Surviving (d) Repulsive

68. SLOBBER

- (a) Sobbing (b) Salivating
(c) Revolting (d) Confusing

69. GREGARIOUS

- (a) Garrulous (b) Determined
(c) Sociable (d) Aloof

70. REJOINER

- (a) A witty reply
(b) To rejoin after taking leaves
(c) Strengthen
(d) Socialise

71. WHISTLE-BLOWER

- (a) A down (b) Informer
(c) A maniac (d) Reformer

72. TRANCHE

- (a) A portion of something, especially money
(b) Waste
(c) Trance
(d) Pit

73. ANGLING

- (a) Activity of hunting
(b) Activity of catching rats
(c) Activity of catching fish
(d) Planning

74. BLOAT

- (a) To become swollen
(b) To shrink
(c) To block
(d) To revolt

75. INCARCERATE

- (a) To decorate
(b) To confine
(c) To kill
(d) To demonstrate

Directions (Q. Nos. 76-119) Each of the following items consists of a sentence followed by four words or group of words. Select the **synonym** of word (occurring in the sentence in capital letters) as per the context.

76. The engineer **ROUGHED OUT** his ideas on a piece of paper while he talked.

- (a) Shaped roughly
(b) Rejected
(c) Drew a quick plan
(d) Described inaccurately

77. He fell into an **ABYSS** of despair.

- (a) Well (b) Deep pit
(c) Sea (d) Hollow

78. He had the **AUDACITY** to interrupt the Governor of the State while the latter was addressing a gathering of academicians.

- (a) Courage (b) Authority
(c) Foolishness (d) Arrogance

79. After weeks of **FRENETIC** activity, the ground was ready for the big match.

- (a) Strenuous (b) Hurried
(c) Excited (d) Hectic

80. The students took **COPIOUS** notes during the lecture delivered by the visiting professor.

- (a) Extensive (b) Exhaustive
(c) Bounteous (d) Abounding

81. Very few people are **IMPERVIOUS** to criticism.

- (a) Impenetrable (b) Unaffected
(c) Unstoppable (d) Unmindful

82. The policemen kept on questioning the criminal but failed to **ELICIT** the truth.

- (a) Evoke (b) Wrest
(c) Obtain (d) Extort

83. Teaching in universities is now considered a **LUCRATIVE** job.

- (a) Risky (b) Profitable
(c) Honourable (d) Undignified

84. A **MENDICANT** old man roamed the streets of the town.

- (a) Punctual (b) Begging
(c) Rich (d) Lazy

85. I do not like **RAPACIOUS** people.

- (a) Hungry (b) Extravagant
(c) Greedy (d) Foolish